THE VICTORY HORASIS INITIATIVE

WHEN TEENS PRAY

Discovering Your Identity and Making the Right Decisions Through Prayer

Why Is This Write-Up Important to Teenagers?

The teenage years are a sensitive stage of life. During this period, young people seek to discover their identity and make decisions that can either build or negatively affect their future.

This pamphlet introduces you to a proven pathway that can help you understand yourself, make godly decisions, and positively influence others.

Two major challenges teenagers face are:

- **Decision-making: Knowing how to make the right choices.**
- **Identity: Understanding who you are.**

Let us briefly explore these challenges and discover how prayer can help us build a strong foundation for adulthood.

1. Decision-Making

Decision-making involves choosing between two or more options. God has given us the ability to make choices, but the decisions we make can either build or destroy our lives.

As teenagers, we encounter choices daily. Sometimes, we make wrong decisions because of ignorance, carelessness, or pressure from others.

How, then, can we make the right decisions? Through prayer and the guidance of God's Word.

2. Identity

Identity is the understanding of who you are. During the teenage years, it is easy to be influenced by people around us, leading us to imitate others and lose sight of who we truly are.

But how can we discover our true identity and make the right decisions?

The answer is PRAYER!

WHAT IS PRAYER?

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Prayer is communication with God. It is one of the ways we relate to Him, express our hearts, and receive guidance through His Word and Spirit.

The Purpose of Prayer

To understand the purpose of prayer, we must first understand what prayer is not:

- **Prayer is not merely asking God for things.**
- **Prayer is not a means of controlling God.**
- **Prayer is not bargaining with God or showing off our spirituality.**

Prayer helps us grow in our relationship with God, understand His will, and experience His wisdom through His answers.

Jeremiah 33:3 says, "Call unto me, and I will answer thee, and shew thee great and mighty things, which thou knowest not."

The effectiveness of our prayers is closely connected to our understanding of God's will.

HOW CAN WE KNOW GOD'S WILL?

God reveals His will through His Word, and we learn to trust and live by it through faith.

John 17:17 says, "Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth."

Key Points to Remember

- **The power of prayer rests in God's power, not our human ability.**
- **God's answers depend on His wisdom, power, and will.**
- **Our understanding of God's character helps us appreciate His answers, even when they differ from our expectations.**

God's Word helps us understand His character and ways (John 15:3).

PRINCIPLES OF PRAYER

Just as healthy relationships require effective communication, our relationship with God requires consistent fellowship with Him.

Three important principles of prayer are:

1. The Word of God

God's Word reveals His will. As teenagers, we must learn to pray in accordance with His will and allow His Word to shape our desires and requests.

To develop an effective prayer life, make studying and understanding the Bible a priority.

2. The Posture of the Heart

Our heart posture refers to our attitude when approaching God. Through His Word, we learn to approach Him with humility, sincerity, and reverence.

Psalm 51:17 says that God will not despise a broken and contrite heart.

God resists the proud but gives grace to the humble (James 4:6).

We must also approach God with reverence and understanding. John 4:24 teaches that those who worship God must worship Him in spirit and in truth.

Just as we show respect when approaching a king, we must approach God with an understanding of His greatness and holiness.

3. Praying According to God's Will

First John 5:14 teaches that when we ask anything according to God's will, He hears us.

Therefore, prayer is not about forcing God to fulfil our desires; it is about trusting Him and aligning our requests with His will.

THE RESULTS OF PRAYER

1. The Fruit of God

John 15:5 says, "I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing."

As we remain connected to Jesus through His Word, prayer, and fellowship, His life becomes evident in us.

This fruit includes godly character, spiritual growth, and the ability to live a life that pleases Him.

2. Knowledge of God and Yourself

Effective communication with God deepens our understanding of His character and helps us discover who we are in Him.

Examples from Scripture:

- **Peter: John 1:41–42; Matthew 16:15–18.**
- **Cornelius: Acts 10.**

Through their encounters with God, we see how He reveals Himself and leads people into greater understanding.

3. Guidance

Making the right decisions is essential during the teenage years because our choices can significantly influence our future.

Through prayer and His Word, God provides guidance.

Psalm 32:8 says that God will instruct us and teach us in the way we should go.

His Word is a lamp to our feet and a light to our path (Psalm 119:105), and the Holy Spirit guides believers into all truth (John 16:13).

God can also use our parents and other godly, trusted people to provide counsel. Therefore, honour your parents, listen to wise advice, and remain willing to obey God's instructions.

HOW CAN YOU HAVE ACCESS TO THE FATHER?

Through Jesus Christ!

Jesus is the way to the Father. John 14:6 says, "I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me."

Through Jesus, we receive salvation and begin a relationship with God.

Dear teenager, if you have not accepted Jesus Christ as your Lord and Saviour, and you desire to know God personally, receive His life, and grow in His guidance, you can pray sincerely:

THE PRAYER OF SALVATION

Lord Jesus, I believe that You died for me so that I may have life in abundance. I confess You as my Lord and personal Saviour. Please save me from sin and its bondage, set me free, and give me Your

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Spirit to help me live according to Your will. Thank You, Lord, because I trust You have heard me. In Jesus' name, Amen.

WELCOME TO YOUR NEW LIFE!

Congratulations on taking this step of faith!

When you place your faith in Jesus Christ, you begin a new life in Him. Do not allow guilt over your past to keep you from growing in God's grace.

Second Corinthians 5:17 says that anyone who is in Christ is a new creation; old things have passed away, and all things have become new.

Romans 8:1 also reminds us that there is no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus.

Dear young believer, take time to study these Scriptures for yourself:

- **1 John 2:12–14**
- **1 John 4:4**
- **Jeremiah 29:13**

Continue to pray, study God's Word, and grow in your relationship with Him.

The Victory Horasis Initiative

For guidance and prayers, please contact us:

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